

CHAPTER – 2

SUICIDES IN INDIA

Each suicide is a personal tragedy that prematurely takes the life of an individual and has a continuing ripple effect, affecting the lives of families, friends and communities. Every year, more than 1,00,000 people commit suicide in our country. There are various causes of suicides like professional/career problems, sense of isolation, abuse, violence, family problems, mental disorders, addiction to alcohol, financial loss, chronic pain etc. NCRB collects data on suicides from police recorded suicide cases.

Rate of suicides has been calculated using projected population for the non-census years whereas for the census year 2011, the population in the Census 2011 Report was used.

A total of 1,71,418 suicides were reported in the country during 2023 showing an increase of 0.3% in comparison to 2022 and the rate of suicides has decreased by 0.8% during 2023 over 2022. **[LIST-2.1]** The incidence and rate of suicides during 2013-2023 is presented in **Table-2.1**.

LIST-2.1

Number of Suicides, Growth of Population and Rate of Suicides during 2019 - 2023

Sl. No.	Year	Total Number of Suicides	Mid-Year Projected Population (in Lakh ⁺)	Rate of Suicides (Col.3/Col.4)
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
1	2019	1,39,123	13376.1 [#]	10.4
2	2020	1,53,052	13533.9 ^{\$}	11.3
3	2021	1,64,033	13671.8 ^{\$}	12.0
4	2022	1,70,924	13797.5 ^{\$}	12.4
5	2023	1,71,418	13923.3^{\$}	12.3

Source: Report of the Technical Group on Population Projections (November, 2019), National Commission on Population, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.

\$ Source: Report of the Technical Group on Population Projections (July, 2020), National Commission on Population, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare

+ One Lakh = 0.1 Million

*** Rate of Suicides = Incidence of suicides per one lakh (1, 00,000) of population.

As per data provided by States/UTs

Number and Percentage Share of Suicides in States/UTs

The State/UT and City wise information on the incidents of suicides, its percentage share in total suicides and rate of suicides during the year are presented in **Table-2.2**.

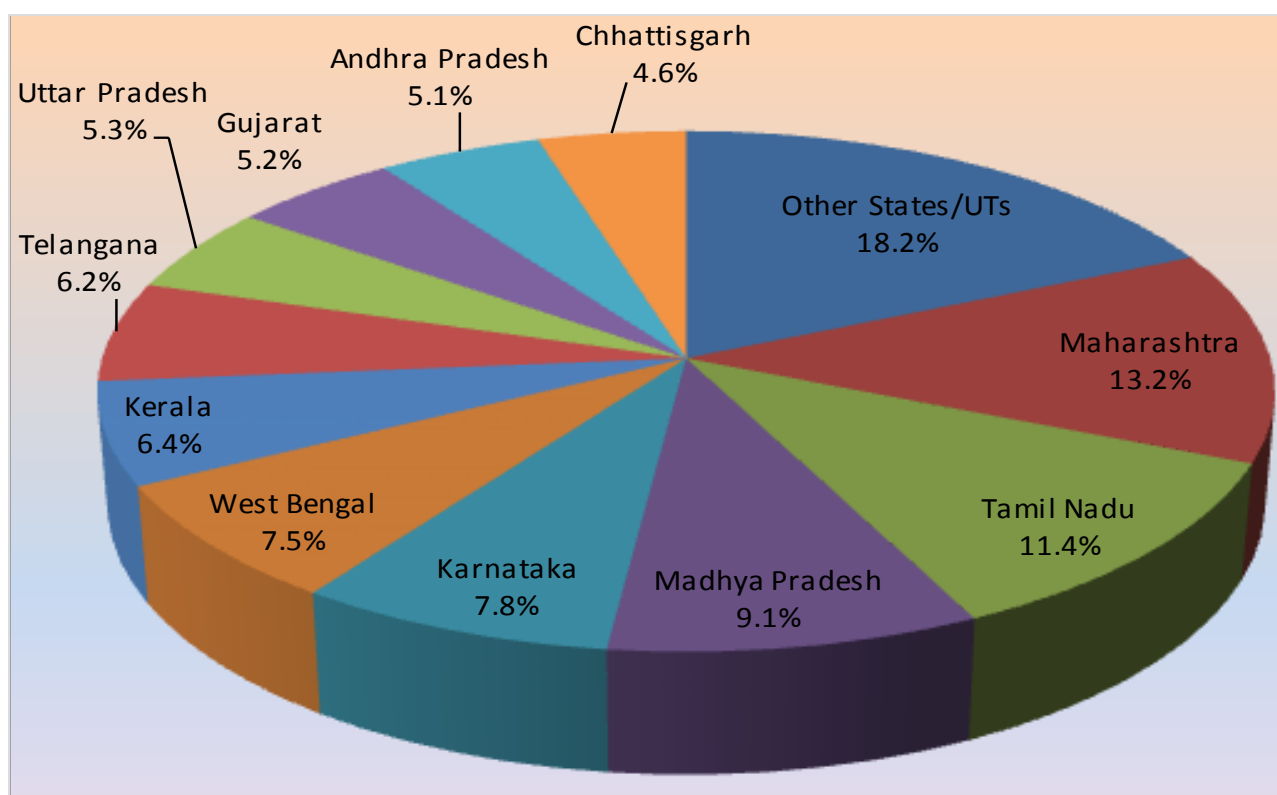
Majority of suicides were reported in Maharashtra (22,687) followed by 19,483 suicides in Tamil Nadu, 15,662 suicides in Madhya Pradesh, 13,330 suicides in Karnataka and 12,819 suicides in West Bengal accounting for 13.2%, 11.4%, 9.1%, 7.8% and 7.5% of total suicides respectively. These 5 States together accounted for 49.0% of the total suicides reported in the country. The remaining 51.0% suicides were reported

in the remaining 23 States and 8 UTs. Uttar Pradesh, the most populous State (17.0% share of country population) has reported comparatively lower percentage share of suicidal deaths, accounting for only 5.3% of the total suicides reported in the country.

The States which have witnessed significantly higher number of suicidal deaths during the year 2021 to 2023 are presented in the **LIST-2.2**. Each of these States have continuously accounted for about 7.0% or more of the total suicides reported in the country from 2021 to 2023.

FIGURE-2.1

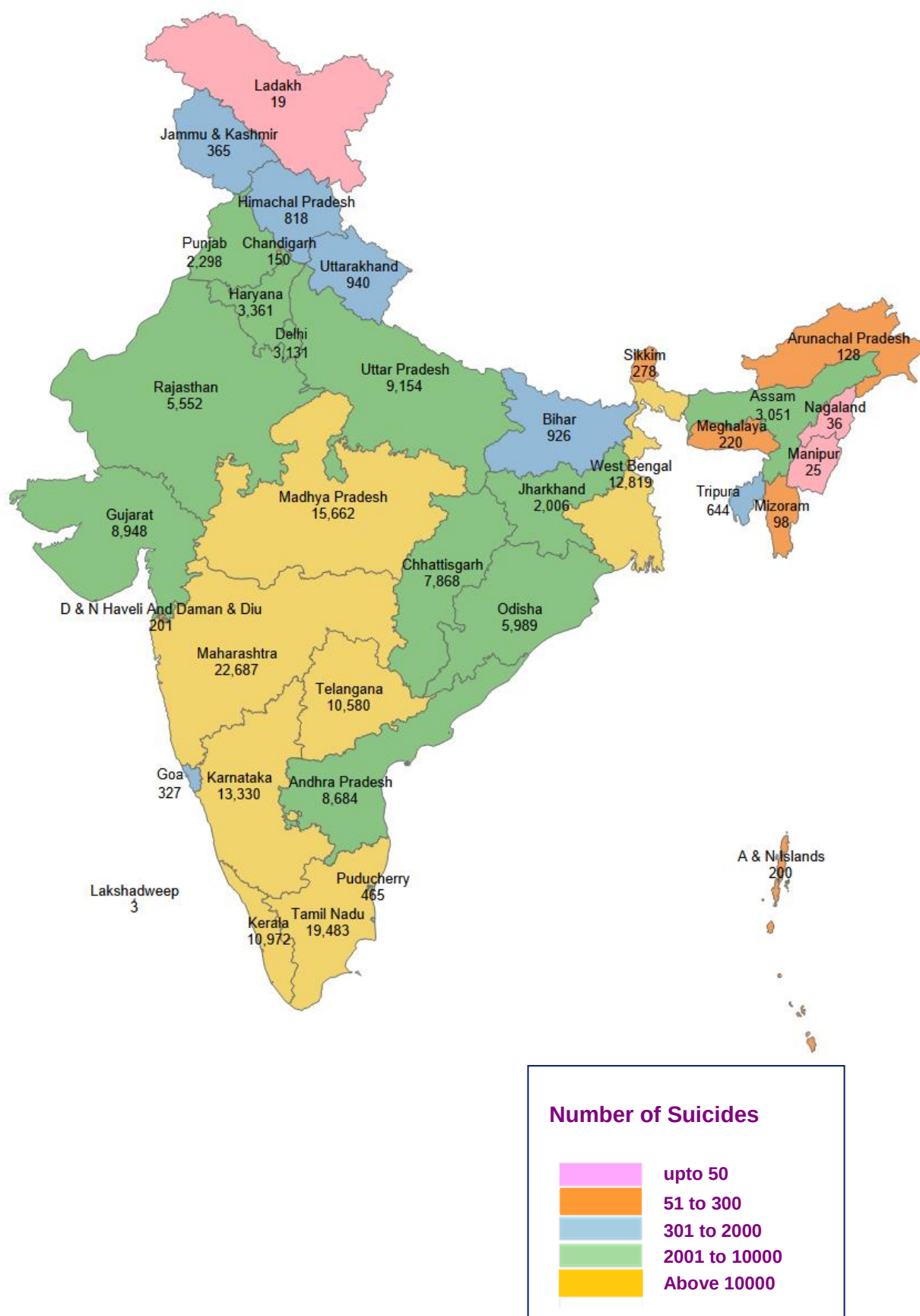
State/UT wise Percentage Share of Suicides in States/UTs during 2023



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Note: Other States/UTs include Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, Goa, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Manipur, Mizoram, Nagaland, Meghalaya, Odisha, Punjab, Rajasthan, Sikkim, Tripura, Uttarakhand, A & N Island, Chandigarh, D & N Haveli & Daman & Diu, Jammu & Kashmir UT, Delhi, Ladakh, Lakshadweep and Puducherry

FIGURE-2.2
STATE/UT – WISE TOTAL NUMBER OF SUICIDES DURING 2023



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

LIST-2.2

States with Higher Percentage Share of Suicides during 2021 to 2023

Sl. No.	Year					
	2021		2022		2023	
1	Maharashtra	(13.5%)	Maharashtra	(13.3%)	Maharashtra	(13.2%)
2	Tamil Nadu	(11.5%)	Tamil Nadu	(11.6%)	Tamil Nadu	(11.4%)
3	Madhya Pradesh	(9.1%)	Madhya Pradesh	(9.0%)	Madhya Pradesh	(9.1%)
4	West Bengal	(8.2%)	Karnataka	(8.0%)	Karnataka	(7.8%)
5	Karnataka	(8.0%)	West Bengal	(7.4%)	West Bengal	(7.5%)

- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Delhi, which is the most-populous UT, has reported the highest number of suicides (3,131) among UTs, followed by Puducherry (465). A total of 26,095 suicides were reported in the 53 mega cities of the country during the 2023.

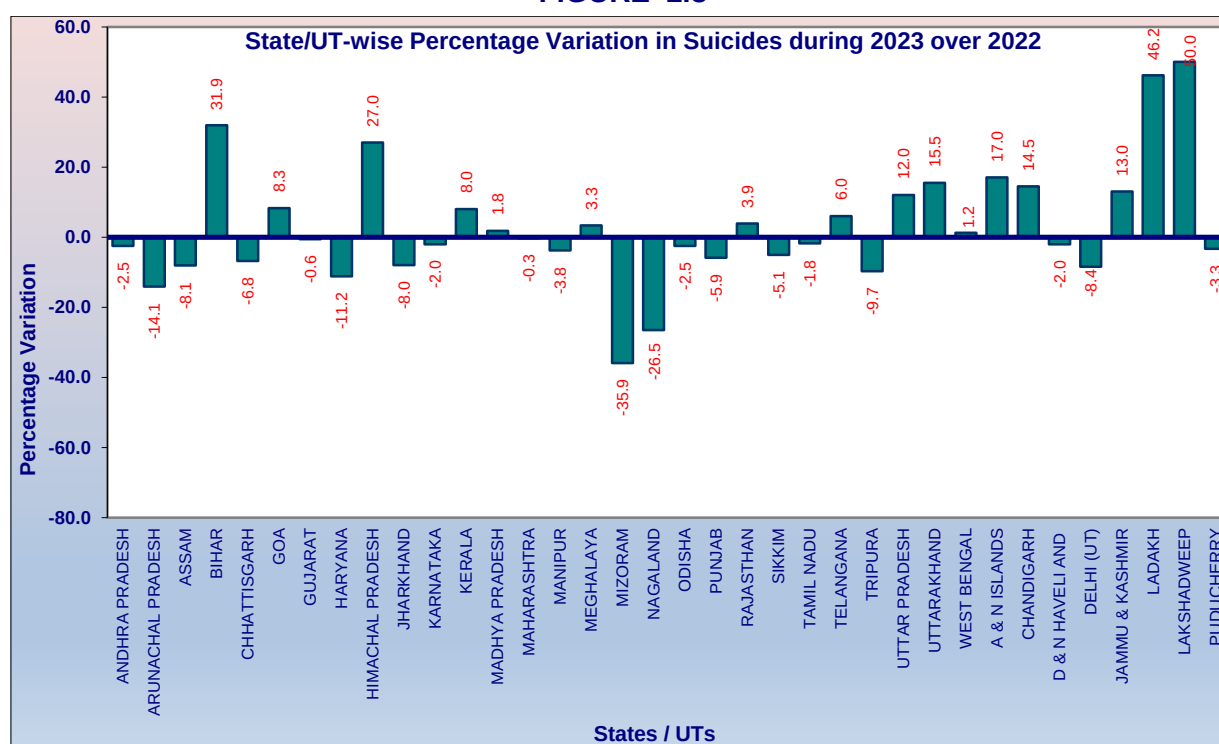
The States and UTs which have reported higher percentage increase in suicides in 2023 over 2022 were Lakshadweep (50.0%), Ladakh (46.2%), Bihar (31.9%), Himachal Pradesh (27.0%), A & N Islands (17.0%), Uttarakhand (15.5%), Chandigarh (14.5%), Jammu & Kashmir UT (13.0%) and Uttar Pradesh (12.0%), while highest percentage decrease was reported in Mizoram (35.9%), Nagaland (26.5%), Arunachal Pradesh (14.1%), Haryana

(11.2%), Tripura (9.7%) and Delhi (8.4%) [Table-2.3, Figure-2.3].

Rate of Suicides — Trend in States/UTs

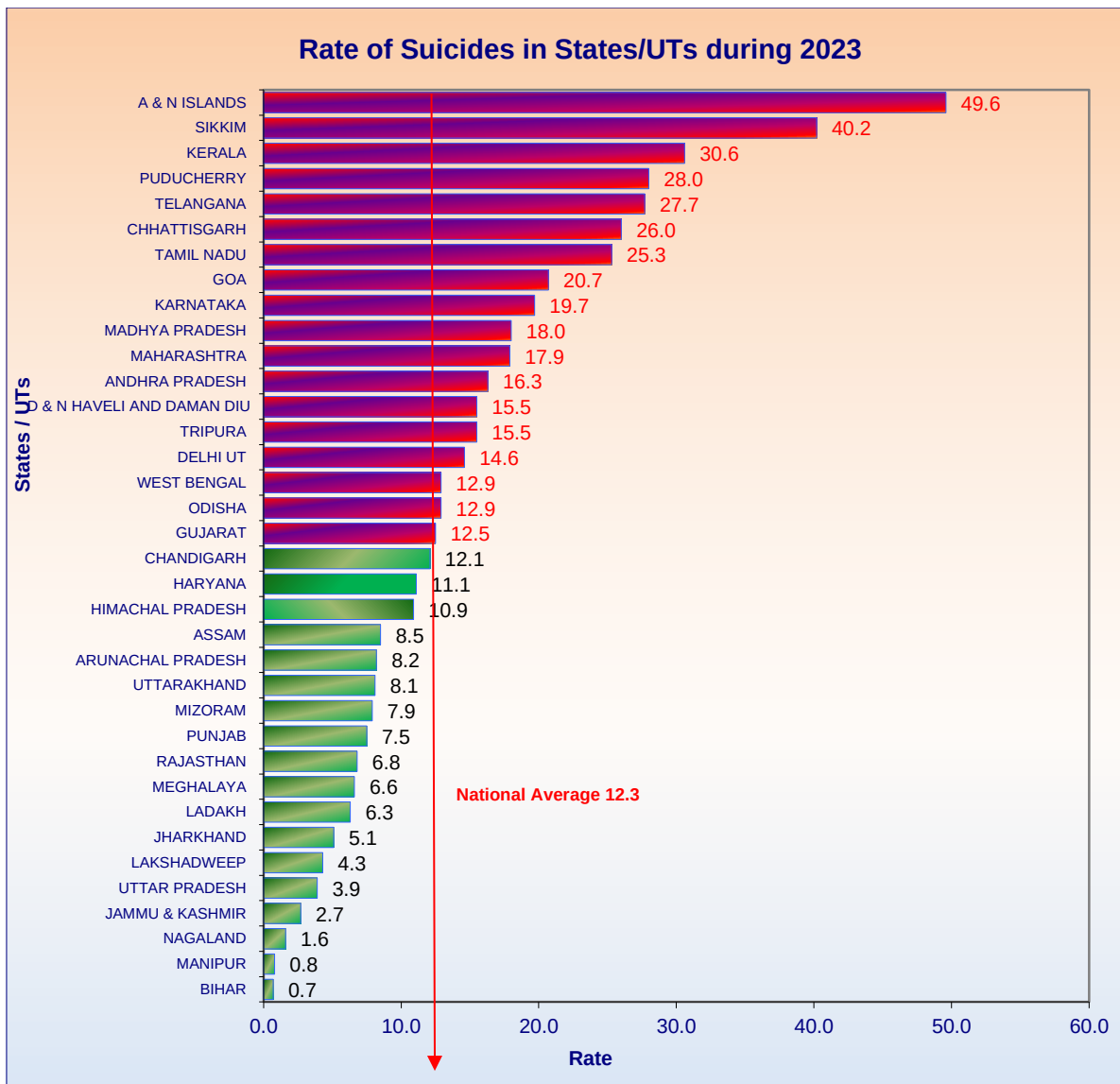
Rate of suicides i.e. the number of suicides per one lakh population, has been widely accepted as a standard yardstick for comparison. All India rate of suicides was 12.3 during the year 2023. A & N Islands reported the highest rate of suicide (49.6) followed by Sikkim (40.2), Kerala (30.6), Puducherry (28.0) and Telangana (27.7) [Figure-2.4]. The details of States/UTs which have recorded higher rate of suicides during 2021 to 2023 are given in LIST-2.3.

FIGURE-2.3



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

FIGURE-2.4



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

FIGURE-2.5
STATE/UT - WISE SUICIDE RATE DURING 2023



Note:

Suicide Rate means Number of Suicides per One Lakh population.

- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Suicide Rate

All India Average 12.4

	upto 2
	2.1 to 5
	5.1 to 10
	10.1 to 20
	Above 20

LIST-2.3
States/UTs with Higher Suicide Rate during 2021 to 2023

		Year			
2021		2022		2023	
A & N Islands	39.7	Sikkim	43.1	A & N Islands	49.6
Sikkim	39.2	A & N Islands	42.8	Sikkim	40.2
Puducherry	31.8	Puducherry	29.7	Kerala	30.6
Telangana	26.9	Kerala	28.5	Puducherry	28.0
Kerala	26.9	Chhattisgarh	28.2	Telangana	27.7
National Rate	(12.0)	National Rate	(12.4)	National Rate	(12.3)

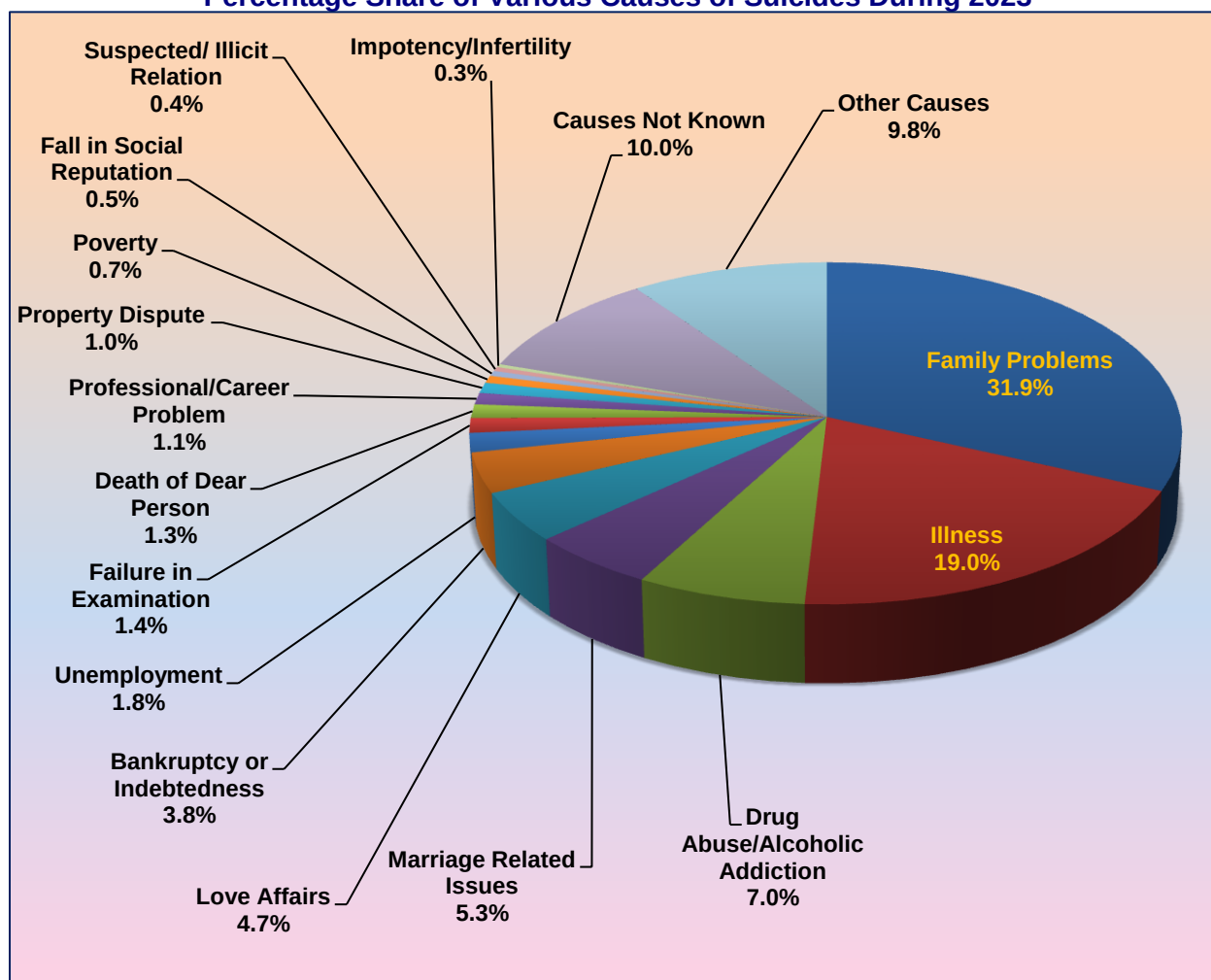
- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Causes of Suicides

'Family Problems' and 'Illness' were the major causes of suicides which accounted for 31.9% and 19.0% of total suicides respectively during 2023. 'Drug Abuse/Alcoholic Addiction' (7.0%), 'Marriage Related Issues' (5.3%), 'Love Affairs' (4.7%), 'Bankruptcy or Indebtedness' (3.8%), 'Unemployment' (1.8%), 'Failure in Examination' (1.4%), 'Death of Dear Person' (1.3%), 'Professional/Career Problem' (1.1%) and 'Property Dispute' (1.0%) were other causes of suicides [Table-2.4].

(5.3%), 'Love Affairs' (4.7%), 'Bankruptcy or Indebtedness' (3.8%), 'Unemployment' (1.8%), 'Failure in Examination' (1.4%), 'Death of Dear Person' (1.3%), 'Professional/Career Problem' (1.1%) and 'Property Dispute' (1.0%) were other causes of suicides [Table-2.4].

FIGURE-2.6
Percentage Share of Various Causes of Suicides During 2023



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

* Figure of Suicides due to ideological causes/hero worshipping, physical abuse and illegitimate pregnancy included in Other Causes.

State and UT wise and City wise details on various causes of suicides are presented in **Table–2.5**. The States/UTs which reported more than the All-India average share under the two major causes of suicides i.e. ‘Family Problems’ and ‘Illness’ are grouped in the **LIST–2.4**.

Suicide Victims by Gender and Age Group

Age group wise distribution of suicides by causes during 2023 is presented in **Table–2.0**. The overall male:female ratio of suicide victims

Professional Status of Suicide Victims

Details on professional status of suicide victims are presented in **Table–2.6**. Housewives accounted for 51.6% of the total female victims (24,048 out of 46,648) and constitute nearly 14.0% of total victims who committed suicides (24,048 out of 1, 71,418) during 2023.

Government servants accounted for 1.1% (1,915) as compared to 7.2% (12,275) from Private Sector Enterprises out of 1, 71,418 of total victims. Employees from Public Sector Undertakings formed 1.4% (2,327), whereas

LIST–2.4
States & UTs Reporting Higher Share of Suicides due to Illness and Family Problems during 2023

Illness				Family Problems			
All India % Share							
19.0				31.9			
Sl. No.	State/UT	Suicides	% Share	Sl. No.	State/UT	Suicides	% Share
1	LAKSHADWEEP	2	66.7	1	ODISHA	4319	72.1
2	PUNJAB	1109	48.3	2	TRIPURA	401	62.3
3	A & N ISLANDS	76	38.0	3	BIHAR	466	50.3
4	TAMIL NADU	6838	35.1	4	TELANGANA	4680	44.2
5	SIKKIM	96	34.5	5	KERALA	4724	43.1
6	LADAKH	5	26.3	6	RAJASTHAN	2364	42.6
7	TRIPURA	168	26.1	7	CHANDIGARH	63	42.0
8	GOA	82	25.1	8	HIMACHAL PRADESH	332	40.6
9	KARNATAKA	3340	25.1	9	UTTAR PRADESH	3621	39.6
10	ANDHRA PRADESH	2116	24.4	10	TAMIL NADU	6608	33.9
11	KERALA	2405	21.9	11	MEGHALAYA	74	33.6
12	GUJARAT	1902	21.3	12	MAHARASHTRA	7503	33.1
13	CHHATTISGARH	1658	21.1	13	ASSAM	983	32.2
14	HARYANA	676	20.1				
15	HIMACHAL PRADESH	160	19.6				
16	MADHYA PRADESH	3063	19.6				

- As per data provided by States/UTs.

for the year 2023 was 72.8 : 27.2, which is greater as compared to year 2022 (71.8 : 28.2). The proportion of female victims were more in ‘Marriage Related Issues’ (specifically in ‘Dowry Related Issues’), and ‘Impotency/Infertility’. The age group (18 - below 30 years) and persons of 30 years - below 45 years of age were the most vulnerable groups resorting to suicides. These age groups accounted for 32.8% and 32.5% suicides respectively. ‘Family Problems’ (2,568), ‘Love Affairs’ (1,724) and ‘Failure in Examination’ (1,303) were the main causes of suicides among children (below 18 years of age).

students and un-employed victims accounted for 8.1% (13,892 victims) 8.3% (14,234 victims) of total suicides respectively. Self-employed category accounted for 11.8% of total suicide victims (20,148 out of 1,71,418).

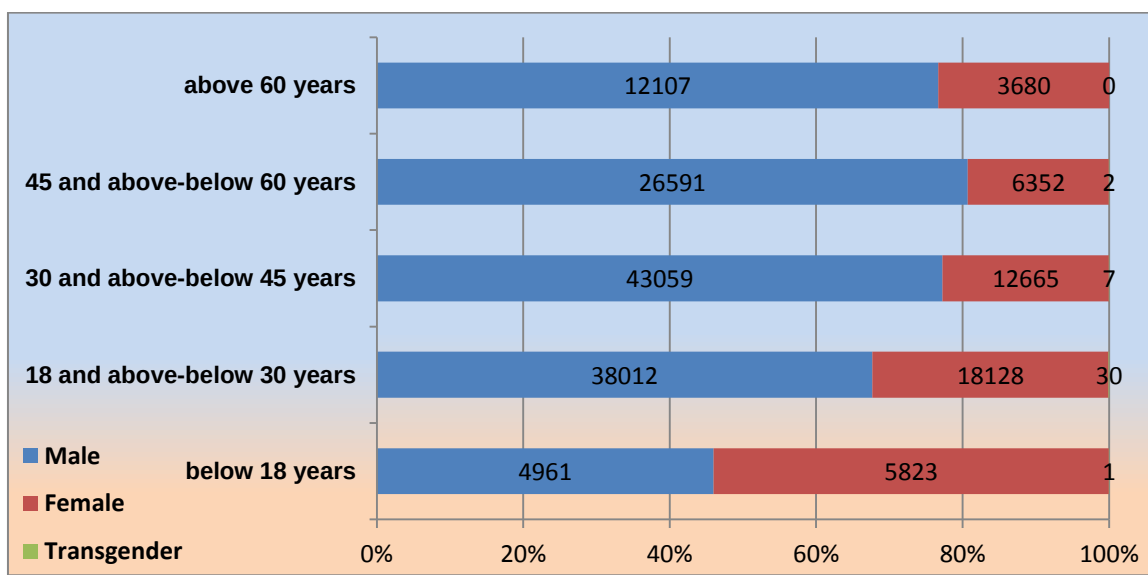
A total of 10,786 persons involved in farming sector (consisting of 4,690 farmers/cultivators and 6,096 agricultural labourers) have committed suicides during 2023, accounting for 6.3% of total suicides victims (1, 71,418) in the country. Out of 4,690 farmer/cultivator suicides, a total of 4,553 were male and 137 were female.

Out of 6,096 suicides committed by agricultural labourers during 2023, 5,433 were male and 663 were female.

Certain States/UTs namely, West Bengal, Bihar, Odisha, Jharkhand, Himachal Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Manipur, Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura, Chandigarh, Delhi(UT) and Lakshadweep reported zero suicides of Farmers/Cultivators as well as Agricultural Labourers.

FIGURE-2.7

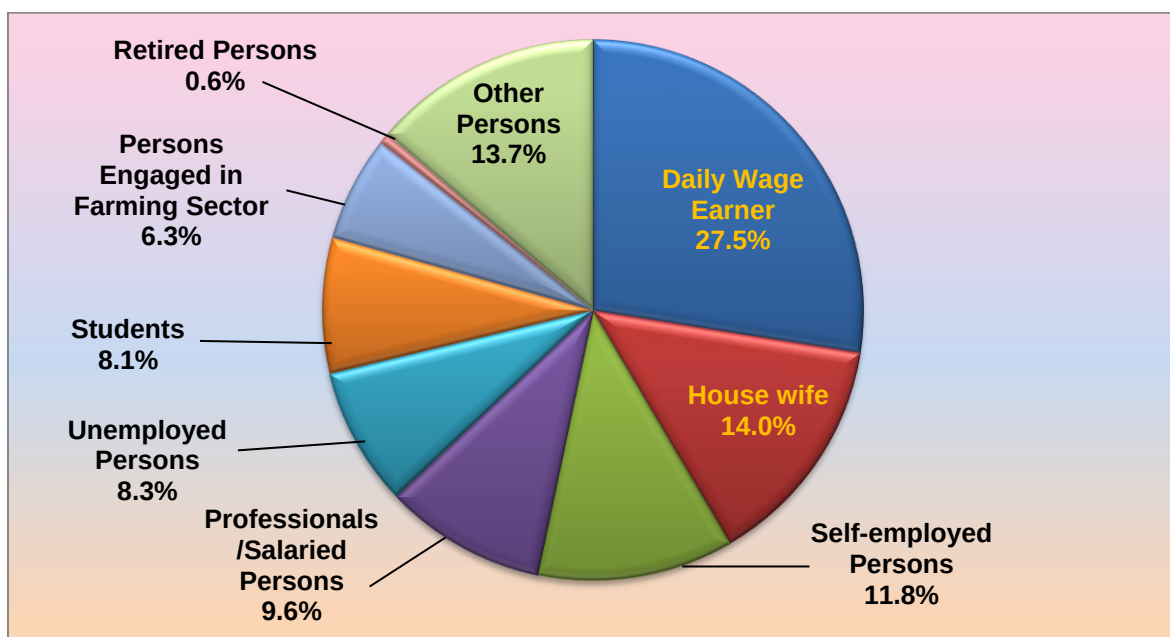
Suicide Victims by Gender and Age Group during 2023



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

FIGURE-2.8

Percentage Distribution of Suicide Victims by Profession During 2023



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Out of total 1,24,730 male suicides, maximum suicides were committed by daily wage earners (42,795) followed by self-employed persons (18,856) and Professionals/Salaried Persons (14,505). A total of 46,648 females committed suicides during 2023 in the country. Of females who committed suicides, highest number (24,048) was of house-wives followed by students (6,559) and daily wage earners (4,365). A total of 40 transgender have committed suicide. Out of 40 transgender, 13 were 'Unemployed Persons' followed by 'Daily Wage Earners' (10), 'Student' (3), 'Self-employed Persons' (2), and 'Professionals/Salaried Persons' (1) while 11 fall under 'Other' category.

State/UT-wise and profession wise analysis of suicide victims is presented in **Table–2.7**. Majority of suicides committed by house-wives were reported in Tamil Nadu (3,080 out of 24,048) followed by Madhya Pradesh (2,637 out of 24,048 suicides) and Maharashtra (2,373 suicides) which accounted for 12.8%, 11.0% and 9.9% of total such suicides during 2023 respectively. Majority of suicides committed by government servants were reported in Tamil Nadu (317 out of 1,915 suicides) followed by Maharashtra (204 suicides), Madhya Pradesh (180 suicides), West Bengal (169 suicides) and Karnataka (138 suicides) which accounted for 16.6%, 10.7%, 9.4%, 8.8% and 7.2% of total such suicides respectively. Majority of suicides committed by persons engaged in Private Sector Enterprises were reported in Maharashtra (2,580 out of 12,275 suicides), Kerala (1,178 suicides), Madhya Pradesh (1,006 suicides), Karnataka (998 suicides) and Tamil Nadu (892 suicides), they accounted for 21.0%, 9.6%, 8.2%, 8.1% and 7.3% of total such suicides respectively. Of total suicides committed by students, 14.7% were reported in Maharashtra (2,046 suicides out of 13,892) followed by 10.5% in Madhya Pradesh (1,459 suicides), 9.9% in Uttar Pradesh (1,373 suicides) and 9.6% in Tamil Nadu (1,339 suicides). Majority of suicides committed by un-employed persons, 15.4% were in Kerala (2,191 out of 14,234 suicides), 14.5% in Maharashtra (2,070 suicides), 11.2% in Tamil Nadu (1,601 suicides) and 9.1% in Uttar Pradesh (1,295 suicides). Majority of suicides committed by persons engaged in business activities were reported by Maharashtra (16.0%), Karnataka (14.1%), Tamil Nadu (8.9%), West Bengal (8.0%), and

Madhya Pradesh (6.8%). Majority of victims engaged in farming sector were reported in Maharashtra (38.5%), Karnataka (22.5%), Andhra Pradesh (8.6%), Madhya Pradesh (7.2%) and Tamil Nadu (5.9%).

Marital Status of Suicide Victims

Marital Status of victims is classified in seven categories namely 'Un-married', 'Married', 'Widowed/Widower', 'Divorcee', 'Separated', 'Others' and 'Status Not Known'.

The information on the marital status of suicide victims is presented in **Table–2.8(I)**. It is observed that 67.0% (1,14,929 out of 1,71,418) of the suicide victims were married while 26.1% were un-married (44,756). Widowed/Widower, Divorcees and Separated have accounted for 1.6% (2,711 victims), 0.6% (1,113 victims) and 0.6% (1,097 victims) of total suicide victims respectively during 2023.

The State/UT-wise information on the marital status of suicide victims is presented in **Table–2.9**.

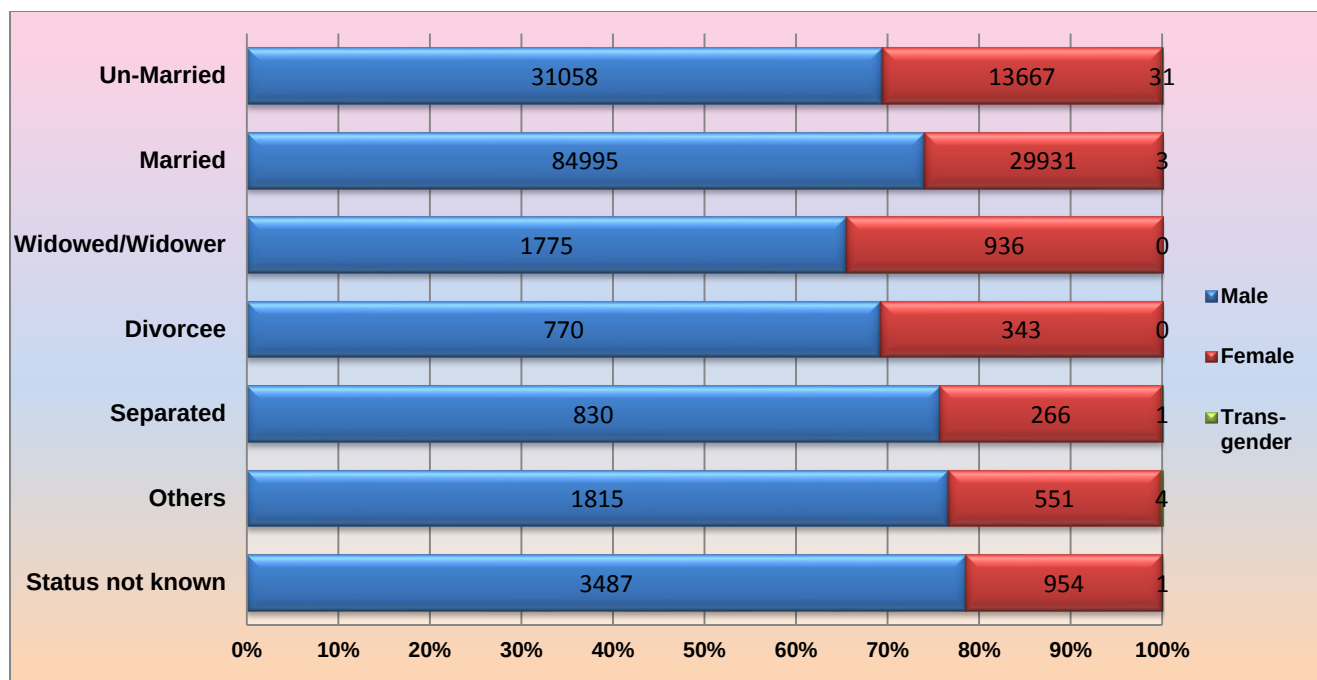
Economic Status of Suicide Victims

The information on the economic status of suicide victims is presented in **Table–2.8(II)**. 66.2% (1,13,416) of suicide victims in 2023 were having annual income of less than ₹1 lakh. 28.3% (48,432) of suicide victims belong to annual income group of '₹1 lakh to less than ₹5 lakh'. The State/UT wise information on the Economic Status of suicide victims is presented in **Table–2.10**.

Educational Status of Suicide Victims

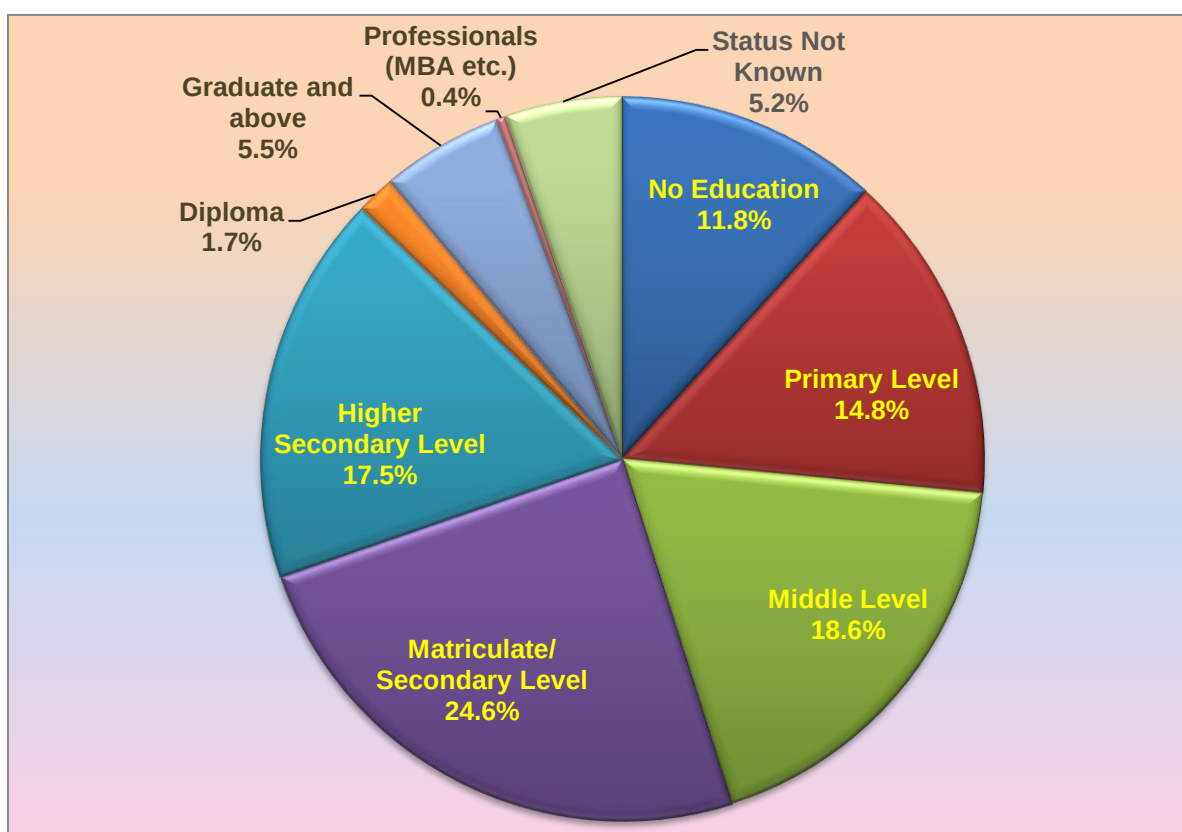
The gender-wise and education-wise break-up of suicide victims is presented in **Table–2.8(III)**. The maximum numbers of suicide victims (24.6%) (42,238) were educated up to Matriculation/ Secondary level, whereas Middle level educated accounted for 18.6% (31,834), Hr. Secondary / Intermediate/Pre-University educated (17.5%) (29,920), Primary educated (14.8%) (25,303), and Illiterate (11.8%) (20,149). Only 5.5% (9,353 out of 1,71,418 victims) of total suicide victims were graduates and above.

FIGURE-2.9
Distribution of Suicide Victims by Marital Status during 2023



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

FIGURE-2.10
Percentage Share of Suicide Victims by Educational Status during 2023



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

LIST-2.5

Percentage of Suicide Victims by Educational Level during 2021– 2023

Sl. No.	Educational Level	Percentage Share		
		2021	2022	2023
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
1	No Education	11.0	11.5	11.8
2	Primary Level	15.8	14.5	14.8
3	Middle Level	19.1	18.0	18.6
4	Matriculate/Secondary Level	24.0	23.9	24.6
5	Higher Secondary Level	16.2	15.9	17.5
6	Diploma	1.2	1.6	1.7
7	Graduate & above	4.6	5.2	5.5
8	Professionals (MBA etc.)	0.3	0.4	0.4
9	Status Not Known	7.8	9.0	5.2
10	Total	100.0	100.0	100.0

- As per data provided by States/UTs.

The State/UT wise information on the Education Status of suicide victims is presented in **Table-2.11**.

Out of 42,238 suicides committed by persons educated up-to matriculate/secondary level, 16.9% were reported in Maharashtra followed by Tamil Nadu (11.1%) and Kerala (9.7%). Out of 31,834 suicides committed by persons educated up-to middle level, 13.8% were reported in Tamil Nadu followed by Maharashtra (12.5%) and Madhya Pradesh (10.0%). Out of 20,149 suicides committed by persons with no education 13.6% were reported in Telangana followed by Madhya Pradesh (12.6%) and Tamil Nadu (10.1%) [**Table-2.11**].

Percentage share of suicide victims by educational level during 2021-23 is presented in **LIST-2.5**.

Means Adopted for Committing Suicides

The means adopted for committing suicide varied from the easily available and effective means such as consumption of poison, jumping etc. to more painful means such as self-inflicted injuries, hanging etc. Like previous year, 'Hanging' (60.9%), consuming 'Poison' (25.0%), 'Drowning' (4.1%) and By Coming under Running Vehicles/Trains (2.8%) were the prominent means/mode of committing suicide. [**Table- 2.12**]

Percentage share of the means adopted in committing suicide during 2022-23 is presented in **LIST-2.6**.

As mode adopted by suicide victims, the share of Drowning (5.0% to 4.1%), 'Fire/Self Immolation' (from 1.8% to 1.5%), 'By Poison' (from 25.4% to 25.0%), 'By Jumping' (from 1.1% to 1.0%), and 'By Coming under Running Vehicles/Trains' (from 2.9% to 2.8%) have decreased while share of 'Hanging' (from 58.2% to 60.9%) and By Touching Electric Wire' (from 0.2% to 0.3%) have increased during 2023 over 2022. [**LIST-2.6**]

The gender-wise break-up and means adopted for suicide in various States/UTs is presented in **Table-2.13**.

LIST-2.6

Percentage of Means/Mode Adopted by Victims to Commit Suicide during 2022-2023

SL.	Means/Mode Adopted	Percentage & Number	
		2022	2023
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
1	Consuming Sleeping Pills	0.4% (753)	0.4% (643)
2	Drowning	5.0% (8,523)	4.1% (7,075)
3	Fire/Self Immolation	1.8% (3,141)	1.5% (2,591)
4	Firearms	0.2% (323)	0.2% (343)
5	By Hanging	58.2% (99,415)	60.9% (1,04,454)
6	By Poison	25.4% (43,387)	25.0% (42,787)
7	By Self inflicting Injury	0.4% (648)	0.4% (637)
8	By Jumping	1.1% (1,947)	1.0% (1,685)
9	By Coming under Running Vehicles/Trains	2.9% (4,880)	2.8% (4,803)
10	By Touching Electric Wire	0.2% (423)	0.3% (451)
11	By Other Means	4.4% (7,484)	3.5% (5,949)
12	Total	100.0	100.0

Note: Bracket () refer to Number of victims who have committed suicides

- As per data provided by States/UTs.

The numbers of male victims were more than females in all means of suicide except those who committed suicides by 'Fire/Self-immolation' where share of female victims was more (1,299 out of 2,591).

Suicides in Cities

City refers to mega city i.e. city having population of 10,00,000 or more.

The numbers of suicides in 53 mega cities show an increasing trend during 2020 to 2022 and decreasing trend during 2023. It increased by 6.5% (to 23,855) in 2020 and increased by 8.8% (to 25,891) in 2021. It increased by 1.5% (to 26,282) in 2022 and decreased by 1.2% (to 26,095) in 2023. Details on year-wise incidents in cities, percentage share to All-India, rate of suicides and percentage change during 2020 - 2023 may be seen in **LIST-2.7**.

However, a total of 1,009 victims have committed suicide in 53 mega cities due to 'Marriage Related Issues' accounting for 3.9% of total suicides in the cities.

Mass/Family Suicides

This section provides information on the number of cases where family members have committed suicide jointly. Mass/Family Suicides were reported in 14 States during the year 2023. State/UT & City-wise information on mass/family suicides is presented in **Table-2.14**.

LIST-2.7

Incidence of Suicides in Mega-Cities, percentage share to All-India, rate of suicides and percentage change over previous year during 2020 – 2023

Year	Suicides in Cities	Cities Share to All India	Rate in Cities	% Variation over Previous Year (Incidence)
2020	23,855	15.6	14.8	6.5
2021	25,891	15.8	16.1	8.8
2022	26,282	15.4	16.4	1.5
2023	26,095	15.2	16.2	-0.7

- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Out of the Mega Cities, the four Metropolitan Cities — Delhi City (3,131), Bengaluru (2,370), Chennai (1,529), and Mumbai (1,415) have reported higher number of suicides. These four cities together have reported almost 32.4% of the total suicides reported from 53 mega cities. Bengaluru has shown an increase of 2.5% (from 2,313 in 2022 suicides to 2,370 suicides in 2023). Delhi City has shown a decline of 7.0% (from 3,367 suicides to 3,131 suicides), Mumbai 5.7% (from 1,501 suicides to 1,415 suicides) and Chennai 3.3% (from 1581 suicides to 1,529 suicides). **[Table-2.3]**

The suicide rate in cities (16.2) was higher as compared to All-India suicide rate (12.3). Kollam followed by Vijayawada have reported the highest suicides rate of 48.6 and 38.7 respectively. **[Table-2.2]**.

'Family Problems (other than marriage related issues)' was the major cause of suicide in cities which accounted for 33.6% (8,756) followed by 'Illness' (15.6%) (4,075) victims out of 26,095 victims.

A total of 131 cases of mass/family suicides were registered during the year 2023. In these suicides, a total of 298 persons, comprising of 190 married persons and 108 unmarried persons, lost their lives.

Maximum cases of mass/family suicides were reported in Tamil Nadu (58 cases) followed by Kerala (17 cases), Rajasthan (12 cases), Madhya Pradesh (9 cases) and Andhra Pradesh (8 cases) during 2023 with a total 120 persons in Tamil Nadu, 40 persons in Kerala, 27 persons in Rajasthan, 21 persons in Madhya Pradesh and 19 persons in Andhra Pradesh losing lives. **[Table-2.14]**

Out of 53 cities, mass/family suicides were reported in 13 cities. These 13 cities have registered 26 cases of mass/family suicides in which 62 persons have committed suicides during 2023. Among these persons, 41 were married and 21 were unmarried persons. **[Table-2.14]**
